

*I sat with Frau Messer at the inn this evening. She poured two glasses of wine, one for me and one for herself, and both were filled to exactly the same line. She did not measure. Her hand simply stopped at the same point.*

*We talked for an hour. She told me about her daughter's wedding preparations. Every detail was in order. The flowers chosen, the menu set, the linens measured. She listed it all with great satisfaction. I asked her if she was happy about the wedding. She said of course. I asked her what she liked best about the young man. She paused for a very long time. Then she said he was punctual.*

*On the walk home the stars were out. I tried to find Orion, but the stars seemed evenly spaced. I am sure this was my imagination.*

– W.L.